

1. Administrative & Study Identification

Full Study Title: Validating Artificial Intelligence Effectiveness Defined Lung Nodule Malignancy Score in Patients With Pulmonary Nodule **Short Title/Acronym:** CREATE **Protocol Number:** D133FR00178 **NCT Number:** NCT05817110 **Sponsor Name:** AstraZeneca **Investigational Product:** qXR (Artificial Intelligence algorithm by Qure.ai reporting Lung Nodule Malignancy Score - LNMS) **Phase of Development:** Observational **Medical Monitor:** AstraZeneca Clinical Operations Lead

2. Study Synopsis & Rationale

2.1 Study Objective **Primary Objective:** To prospectively validate an AI-derived lung nodule malignancy score (qXR-LNMS) against radiologist assessment of CT scans and Lung-RADS in patients with an incidental pulmonary nodule (IPN) on chest radiographs. **Secondary Objectives:** To evaluate the Positive Predictive Value (PPV) and Negative Predictive Value (NPV) of the LNMS by clinico-demographic characteristics, assess concordance with established models (e.g., Mayo Clinic model), and track long-term nodule management and clinical outcomes.

2.2 Background & Rationale While low-dose CT (LDCT) is the gold standard for lung cancer screening, its large-scale adoption in resource-constrained settings is limited by cost and infrastructure. AI-based algorithms (like qXR) applied to routine chest X-rays (CXR) have demonstrated increased accuracy in predicting lung cancer risk. This study aims to generate real-world evidence validating this AI tool to stratify high- and low-risk patients with IPNs, ultimately optimizing LDCT referrals and early detection, especially for patients falling outside traditional smoking-based screening criteria.

3. Study Design & Methodology

3.1 Design Framework **Study Type:** Observational (Prospective) **Control Type:** Single-arm (Observational Cohort) **Blinding:** Open-label (Independent radiologist CT review blinded to AI score for validation) **Randomization:** N/A

3.2 Planned Enrollment & Duration **Target N\$:** 713 participants **Number of Sites:** Multicentric, multinational (including sites in India, Indonesia, Mexico, Turkey, and Egypt) **Estimated Study Start:** 20-Apr-2023 **Estimated Primary Completion:** 06-Dec-2026

4. Subject Selection (Eligibility Criteria)

4.1 Inclusion Criteria 1. Male or female patients aged ≥ 35 years. 2. Patients diagnosed with an incidental pulmonary nodule (IPN) on chest X-ray (CXR) ordered by their treating clinician. 3. Nodule detected by the qXR algorithm and confirmed by the site radiologist, with a nodule size ≥ 8 and ≤ 30 mm.

4.2 Exclusion Criteria 1. Patients without a confirmed incidental pulmonary nodule. 2. Inability or refusal to provide written informed consent to participate in the study or to undergo the confirmatory low-dose CT scan. 3. Previously diagnosed with lung cancer or actively undergoing lung cancer treatment.

5. Intervention & Treatment Plan

5.1 Investigational Regimen Dosage/Frequency: N/A (Software as a Medical Device. The AI diagnostic algorithm is applied to a baseline CXR, followed by a confirmatory CT scan). **Route of Administration:** N/A (In silico diagnostic imaging software). **Duration of Treatment:** Baseline imaging assessment (Phase 1) followed by a 24-month observational clinical follow-up period (Phase 2).

5.2 Concomitant & Prohibited Therapy Permitted: Standard of care for lung nodule management, including follow-up imaging and biopsies as directed by the treating physician. **Prohibited:** N/A (Observational study).

6. Study Timeline & Visit Schedule

Visit ID	Window (Days)	Key Activities/Procedures
Screening	Day 0	Routine CXR performed; qXR algorithm processes the image to detect IPNs.
Baseline (Phase 1)	Enrollment	Informed Consent, AI-based LNMS classification (high/low risk), radiologist confirmation, baseline CT scan requested.
Interim (Phase 2)	Up to Month 24	Clinical follow-up visits per standard of care; not mandatory study-specific visits.
End of Study	Month 24 (post-CT)	Final data collection regarding nodule management, malignancy status, and clinical outcomes.

7. Outcome Measures (Endpoints)

7.1 Primary Endpoint Definition: Positive predictive value (PPV) and negative predictive value (NPV) of the AI-defined lung nodule malignancy score (qXR-LNMS). (Pre-defined threshold for success: $\geq 20\%$ for PPV and $\geq 70\%$ for NPV). **Measurement Method:** Comparison of the binary qXR-LNMS categorization (high or low

risk) with the independent radiologist-based assessment of CT scans (using a 1-5 Likert scale) and Lung-RADS score.

7.2 Secondary & Exploratory Endpoints * Concordance between the AI model and the Mayo Clinic lung cancer risk model. * Subgroup analysis of PPVs and NPVs by clinical and demographic characteristics (e.g., smoking history, age). * Long-term clinical outcomes and diagnostic pathway tracking over 24 months.

8. Safety & Adverse Event Reporting

Adverse Event (AE) Monitoring: This is a minimal-to-no-risk observational study. AE monitoring is restricted to standard clinical care tracking. **Serious Adverse Events (SAEs):** Reported per standard observational study guidelines. **Data Monitoring Committee (DMC):** Supervised and audited by AstraZeneca and Qure.ai clinical research teams.

9. Statistical Analysis Plan (SAP) Summary

Analysis Populations: All enrolled participants with a confirmed IPN who underwent both the AI-analyzed CXR and the subsequent CT scan. **Sample Size Justification:** A target of ~713 participants was determined to provide sufficient statistical power to cross the predefined success thresholds of at least 20% PPV and 70% NPV. **Handling of Missing Data:** Standard imputation methods applicable to observational diagnostic accuracy studies.

10. Quality Assurance & Regulatory Compliance

GCP Compliance: This study will be conducted in accordance with Good Clinical Practice (GCP) and the Declaration of Helsinki. **Monitoring Plan:** Data collection monitoring from initial CXR/qXR assessment (Phase 1) through the 24-month observational period (Phase 2). **Audit Trail:** eCRF tracking of qXR-LNMS scores, local radiologist reports, and independent, blinded radiologist CT scan assessments.

11. Study Identifiers & Governance

Primary ID: D133FR00178 **Registry Number:** NCT05817110 **Sponsor/Lead Organization:** AstraZeneca **Study Title:** CREATE (Validating Artificial Intelligence Effectiveness Defined Lung Nodule Malignancy Score in Patients With Pulmonary Nodule) **Official Regulatory Title:** A multicentric, multinational, prospective, observational study to validate qXR-Lung nodule malignancy score as a binary categorization of the risk of Lung cancer as high or

low among patients with an incidental pulmonary nodule (IPN) on chest radiographs.

12. Clinical Framework (Lung Nodule Specific)

Primary Condition: Incidental Pulmonary Nodule (IPN) / Lung Malignancy **Diagnosis Threshold:** Nodule size ≥ 8 mm and ≤ 30 mm on CXR **Medical Methodology:** AI-enabled analysis of chest radiographs (qXR-LNMS) validated against LDCT **Optimization Target:** Early detection and risk-based screening of lung cancer

13. Study Procedures & Methodology

Management Pathway: Clinical follow-up and LDCT assessment based on standard of care for IPNs **Education Protocol (HCP):** Instruction on qXR AI algorithm reporting, LDCT guidelines, and Lung-RADS scoring **Education Protocol (Patient):** Informed consent for low-dose CT and long-term observational follow-up **Quality Audit Mechanism:** Independent radiologist review of the CT scan compared to the AI-derived LNMS

14. Observation & Follow-Up Schedule

Total Duration: Approximately 30 months from enrollment (24 months post-CT data collection) **Onsite Visit Cadence:** Baseline CXR and CT Scan visit (Phase 1), followed by routine clinical follow-up (Phase 2) **Remote Monitoring Frequency:** Periodic data collection at End of Phase 1 and throughout Phase 2 **Checklist Review Interval:** Final evaluation at the 24-month follow-up mark

15. Sign-off & Approval

Role	Name	Signature	Date	:--	:--	:--	:--
Principal Investigator	[Name]	_____	[DD-MMM-YYYY]				
Clinical Operations Lead	[Name]	_____	[DD-MMM-YYYY]				Lead
Statistician	[Name]	_____	[DD-MMM-YYYY]				